

**Mad Max Lineup Release**

Mad Max prequel - "Furiosa" set for a 2023 release, alongside "Coyote vs ACME" and "The Color Purple". <http://dgit.in/jan21-29>

**Pretend It's A City**

Directed by Scorsese, the documentary follows Fran Lebowitz, as she shares her views on life in the NYC. <http://dgit.in/jan21-30>

iFight!

Apple vs Facebook – Booman takes no sides

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

Those who have read this column regularly will know that I hate gatekeepers. Especially if there is a monopoly, gatekeepers are inherently evil. One of those companies is Google, whose motto of "Don't be evil" is in direct conflict with their business as a gatekeeper. The same applies to Facebook, and, sorry fanboys, Apple as well. These big three of the technology world have got us by the nuts, and they know it. When growth slows, that's when they start squeezing.

Apple announced changes to its iOS platform that will roll out early next year. Apple will show a popup over any apps which use targeted advertising by accessing user data, which will inform a user with a message that will, in different words, say, "This app tracks you. Allow it to? Ask it not to?" Until a user taps on Allow it to, we're assuming Apple will block access to user data, though it's unclear what happens, and will be made clearer when Apple rolls this feature out in 2021.

Facebook, which is one of the most popular apps on all phones, and thus also on iOS, is up in arms about this. Why? Because its business model is built on tracking people and offering up relevant advertising. We all know this, because when we search for, say, a new toaster on Google and visit some sites selling toasters, we start seeing ads for toasters everywhere. This includes Google ads and also on Facebook. So what was Facebook's

reaction? It bought full page ads in newspapers about how Apple would be hurting small businesses with this move, and then it released another set of ads talking about how things on the internet will get more expensive with this move by Apple. Newspapers? Who reads those anymore in the US, right? Politicians? A very vocal group of people above the age of 40 who aren't afraid of writing to their local politician?



Does Facebook really care about small businesses? A lot of Facebook's own employees don't think so. In fact they think that Facebook is using the small businesses as a front, but the real business that will be affected is Facebook itself. Remember, this comes at a time when Facebook is facing a lawsuit that seeks to break the company up, and alleging anti-trust violations. While there's no such case against Apple, yet, there are rumours that a lot of policy makers are unhappy with the big four technology companies (Amazon, Apple, Alphabet and Facebook), and are looking to regulate them in some way.

So what does Facebook hope to gain here? I think it's crying foul, warning

its own investors of being hurt by Apple, dropping its share prices, and signalling to politicians across the US and EU, "Hey, you're focussed on the wrong company! I'm the little guy, it's that big brute over there (Apple) that you should be regulating instead!"

What's Apple's end game? Does it care about its customers and their privacy? Yes, because it doesn't make money off that data, someone else does. If there's one thing Apple hates is someone making money and not giving Apple their pound of flesh! Ask the makers of Fortnite how much Apple hates not getting a piece of the pie! Apple wants that pie to be an apple pie, and it wants to make a profit off the baker who bakes it, the apple vendor, the flour mill, and of course, it wants to charge you a premium as well!

Not content with making billions of its hardware, Apple also wants to make billions of its app store. It wants you to buy a phone without a charger and then pay premium for one. It's end goal has always been to try and lock up users willing to pay premium prices in its own ecosystem. What it does have going for it is the ability to cajole its users into believing that it isn't evil, greedy and power hungry, and that it alone cares for users. All hogwash of course!

Whichever way you look at it, both Apple and Facebook are fighting for control over you. Both want your money. Apple just demands it more directly by pretending to care, all the while keeping one hand firmly in your pocket and limiting choice by making others seem bad. Meanwhile, Facebook (and Google, and Amazon and the rest) want to offer you material comfort and to get you to buy more stuff by profiling you and trying to sell you junk that you cannot resist.

Whether you waste money on a toaster that has WiFi for no sane reason, or a charger and dongles for your iPhone that Apple could have easily provided... you are going to spend your money. They may iFight, but you're the one getting beaten up! 